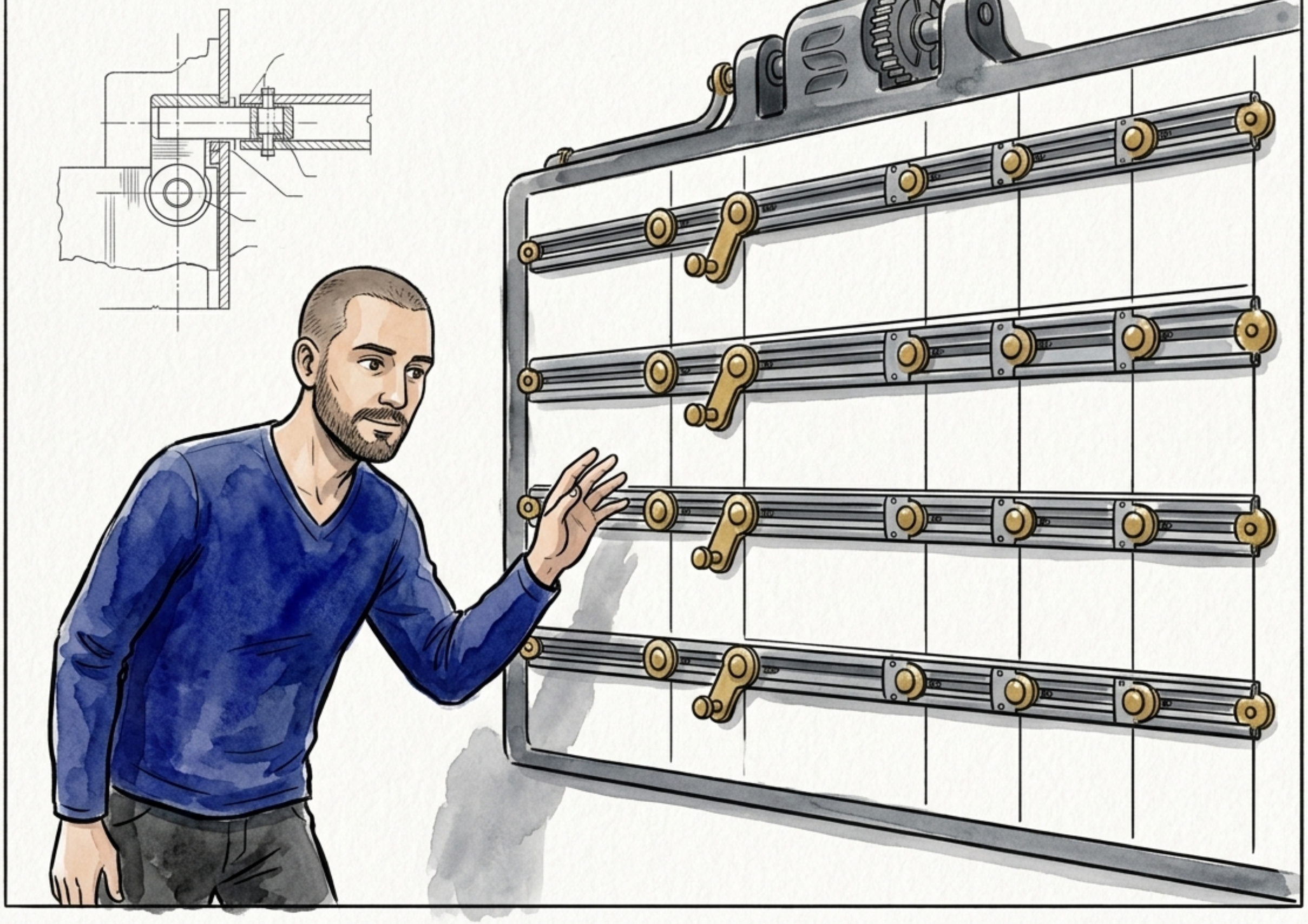


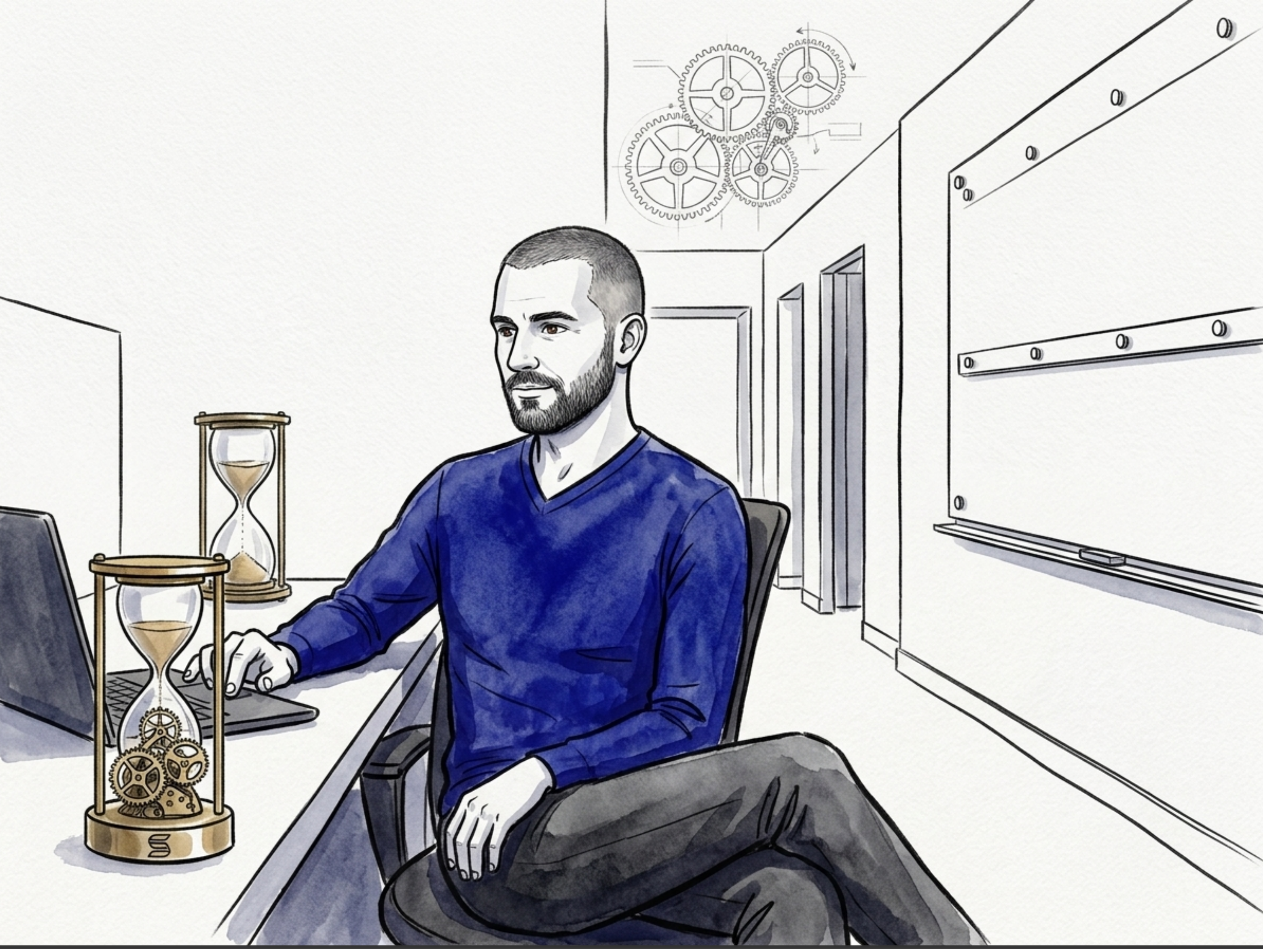
The invite shows up declined again.

You are already writing the story about what it means, and it is usually the harshest one.



One cancellation is noise.

A pattern is information, and it is mostly about your manager's state, not your work.



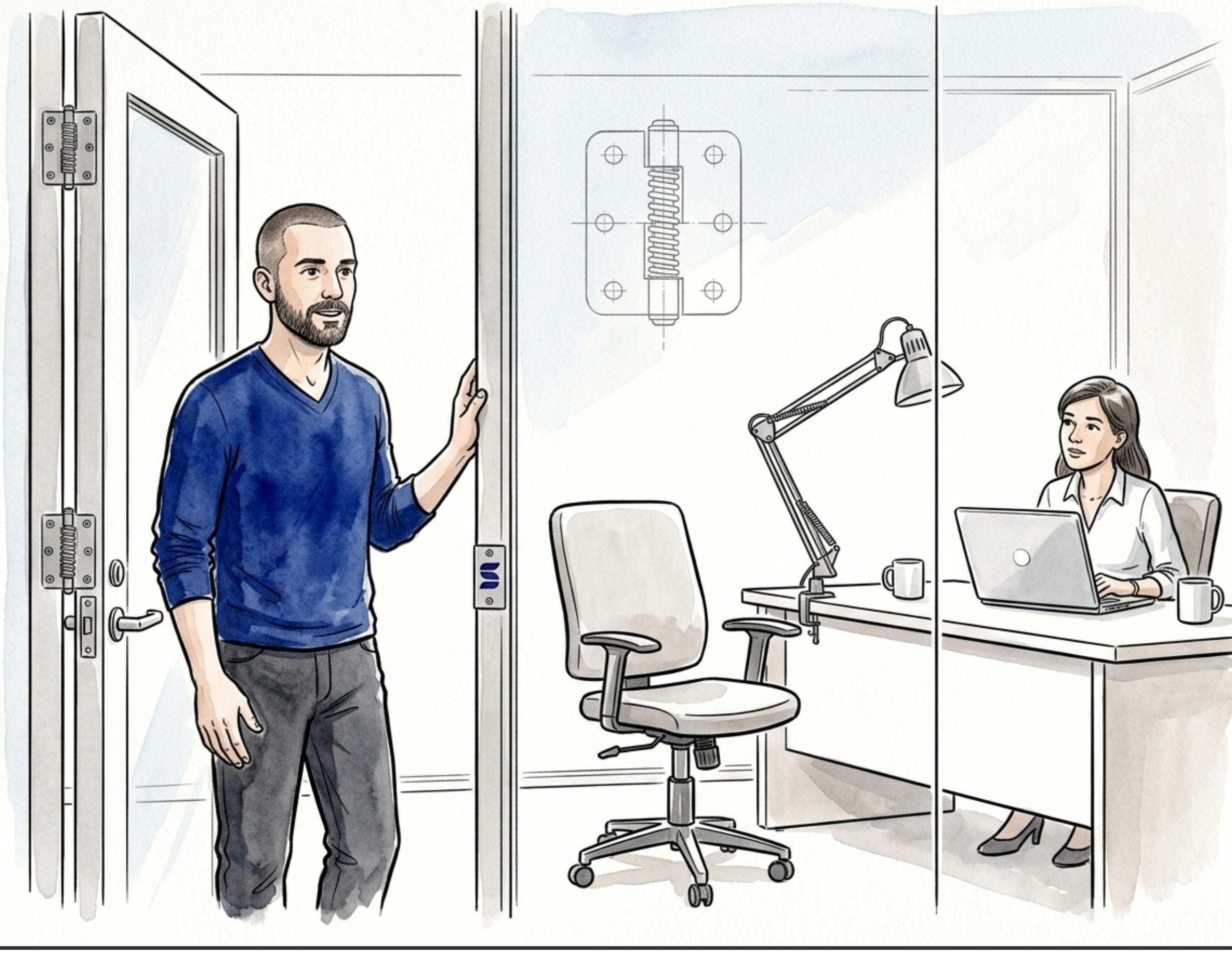
I had a manager with no 1-on-1s.

They never scheduled unless they needed something. So I emailed my priorities and what I would do, and once gave them one hour to stop me.



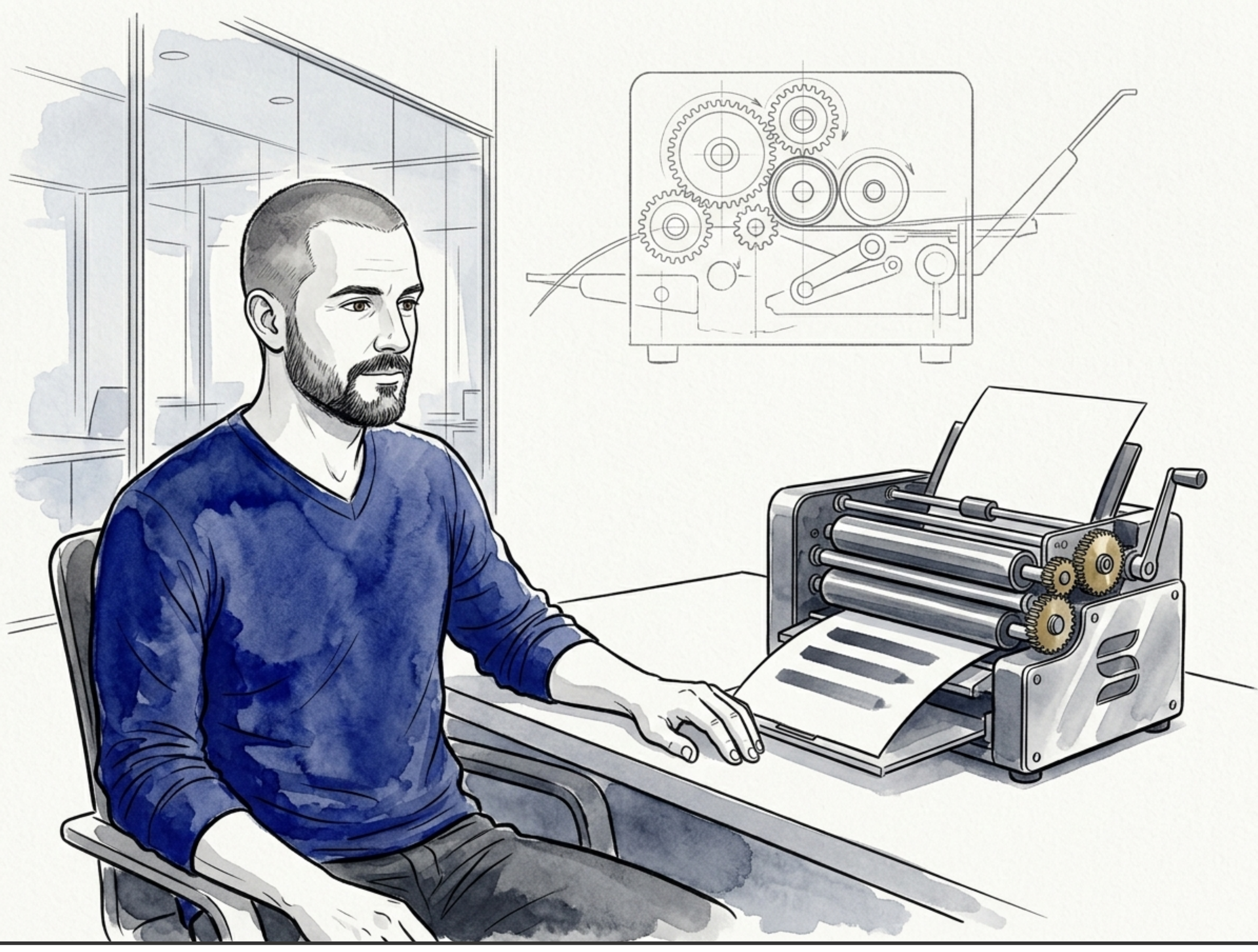
No news is not good news.

A manager fine with no 1-on-1s is either aligned with you or actively disengaged. From outside, it looks the same.



1. Name the pattern without accusing.

Skip "you keep cancelling." Ask if a fixed biweekly slot works. A slot that always happens beats a weekly one that happens half the time.



2. Make the note your 1-on-1.

Send three lines: what I am working on, what I plan to do next, what I need from you.